3 THE END OF THE PRESENT

It opens
to this gentle breeze
of Spring
the sealed-in cold
of the still season,
and the boats return to the sea . . .
Now we must braid
crowns with which
to adorn our heads. (I, 4)

SPEED ALSO SLOWS DOWN TIME

Ten years before understanding that time is slowed down by mass,[21] Einstein had realized that it was slowed down by speed.[22] The consequence of this discovery for our basic intuitive perception of time is the most devastating of all.

The fact itself is quite simple. Instead of sending the two friends from the first chapter to the mountains and the plains, respectively, let's ask one of them to stay still and the other one to walk around. Time passes more slowly for the one who keeps moving.

As before, the two friends experience different durations: the one who moves ages less quickly, his watch marks less time passing; he has less time in which to think; the plant he is carrying takes longer to germinate, and so on. For everything that moves, time passes more slowly.